Generated from the competition table

1981 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 1981, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner	National team	Ceremony date
Karl-Heinz Rummenigge	West Germany	29 December 1981

← Previous edition (PDF)
1980

Next edition (PDF) →
1982

All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →

📚 References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed:23 October 2026

- Official winners and rankings (https://ballondor.com/all-rankings)
- Official homepage (https://ballondor.com/)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 1 of 5) (https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 2 of 5) (https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 3 of 5) (https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-decembre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 4 of 5) (https://www.voanews.com/)

- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 5 of 5) (https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 1 of 9) (https://www.si.com/soccer/what-is-the-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees-2025)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 2 of 9) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 3 of 9) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/kopa-trophy.htm)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 4 of 9) (https://www.sportsdunia.com/football-analysis/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 5 of 9) (https://www.chaseyoursport.com/football/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners/8061)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 6 of 9) (https://www.givemesport.com/every-winner-kopa-trophy-ranked/)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 7 of 9) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kopa_Trophy)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 8 of 9) (https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/football/first-team/news/4367534/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy/featured)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 9 of 9) (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2025/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy-for-best-young-player-vicky-lopez-takes-inaugural-womens-prize_sto23224406/story.shtml)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 1 of 11) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/yashin-trophy.htm)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 2 of 11) (https://www.premierleague.com/en/news/4420829/donnarumma-and-gyokeres-win-awards-at-2025-ballon-dor)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 3 of 11) (https://goaltheball.com/yashin-trophy-winners-list/)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 4 of 11) (https://www.fotmob.com/el/news/x3syvn394xhu179pkuk2k9k4y/ballon-d'or-2019-liverpool-goalkeeper-alisson-wins-inaugural-yachine-trophy)

- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 5 of 11) (https://www.goal.com/en-ca/lists/aston-villa-and-argentina-goalkeeper-emiliano-martinez-retains-yashin-trophy-as-world-s-best-goalkeeper-in-2024/blt47f77564722f26b5)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 6 of 11) (https://fr.wikipedia.org/wiki/Troph%C3%A9e_Yachine)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 7 of 11) (https://www.footmercato.net/a7278391082899020163-ballon-dor-2025-gianluigi-donnarumma-remporte-le-trophee-yachine)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 8 of 11) (https://www.realmadrid.com/en-US/news/football/first-team/special-features/courtois-yashin-trophy-winner-2022)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 9 of 11) (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2022/ballon-dor-2022-thibaut-courtois-wins-yashin-trophy-for-best-goalkeeper-after-real-madrid-heroics-la_sto9191911/story.shtml)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 10 of 11) (https://www.90min.com/posts/emiliano-martinez-wins-2023-yashin-trophy)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 11 of 11) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/emiliano-martinez-wins-back-to-back-yachine-trophy-awards-1335839)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 1 of 10) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/striker-of-the-year.htm)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 2 of 10) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-gerd-muller-trophy-past-winners-nominees)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 3 of 10) (https://www.gamereactor.eu/what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy-and-who-will-win-this-year-at-ballon-dor-2025-1605433/)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 4 of 10) (https://www.arsenal.com/news/viktor-gyokeres-wins-gerd-muller-trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 5 of 10) (https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/muller-trophy-for-year%E2%80%99s-best-striker-awarded-for-the-first-time-at-the-ballon-dor-ceremony)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 6 of 10) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gerd_M%C3%BCller_Trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 7 of 10) (https://www.bavarianfootballworks.com/2022/10/18/23409746/robert-lewandowski-striker-award-2022-gerd-muller-fc-barcelona-bayern-munich-alum-haaland-benzema)

- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 8 of 10) (https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/news/2858120/lewandowski-wins-inaugural-gerd-muller-trophy/featured)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 9 of 10) (https://www.fourfourtwo.com/features/ballon-dor-what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 10 of 10) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/won-gerd-muller-trophy-2025-201726350.html)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 1 of 9) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johan_Cruyff_Trophy_(France_Football))
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 2 of 9) (https://www.goal.com/en-us/lists/carlo-ancelotti-men-s-coach-of-year-ballon-d-or-ceremony-xabi-alonso-pep-guardiola/blt4f9630905d966f8d)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 3 of 9) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/real-madrid-boss-ancelotti-wins-men-s-johan-cruyff-trophy-1335838)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 4 of 9) (https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/articles-video/ancelotti-is-the-best-coach-of-the-year-2024-10-28)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 5 of 9) (https://www.managingmadrid.com/2024/10/28/24282158/carlo-ancelotti-wins-coach-of-the-year-award)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 6 of 9) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/psg-head-coach-luis-enrique-193800045.html)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 7 of 9) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/luis-enrique-wins-2025-johan-cruyff-trophy-for-world-s-best-coach-1374497)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 8 of 9) (https://www.caughtoffside.com/2025/09/22/ballon-dor-2025-luis-enrique-best-coach/)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 9 of 9) (https://tribuna.com/en/news/2025-09-22-luis-enrique-wins-johan-cruyff-trophy-at-2025-ballon-dor/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 1 of 11) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/S%C3%B3crates_Award)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 2 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/socrates-award/)

- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 3 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/the-senegalese-sadio-mane-becomes-the-first-winner-of-the-socrates-award-at-the-2022-ballon-dor-ceremony/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 4 of 11) (https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/sadio-mane-the-inaugural-winner-of-the-socrates-award)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 5 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/vinicius-junior-wins-socrates-award-at-the-2023-ballon-dor-ceremony/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 6 of 11) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/vinicius-wins-socrates-2023-award-for-his-humanitarian-work-1287586)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 7 of 11) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-socrates-award-past-winners-nominees)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 8 of 11) (https://www.olympics.com/en/news/ballon-dor-2025-all-winners-all-awards-complete-list-live-updates)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 9 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/h-s-h-prince-albert-ii-and-peace-and-sport-welcome-the-xana-foundation-winner-of-the-2025-socrates-award-in-monaco-2/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 10 of 11) (https://www.monaco-tribune.com/en/2025/09/ballon-dor-2025-ceremony-princess-charlene-presents-socrates-prize-to-xana-foundation/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 11 of 11) (https://www.gamereactor.eu/luis-enriques-xana-foundation-named-after-his-late-daughter-wins-socrates-award-for-humanitarian-work-1605953/)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 1 of 8) (https://www.si.com/soccer/kopa-trophy-list-winners-most-wins-all-time)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 2 of 8) (https://www.si.com/soccer/yashin-trophy-list-winners-most-wins-all-time)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 3 of 8) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/award-striker-of-the-year.htm)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 4 of 8) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johan_Cruyff_Trophy_(France_Football))

- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 5 of 8) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/S%C3%B3crates_Award)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 6 of 8) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/jenni-hermoso-winner-of-the-socrates-award-at-the-2024-ballon-dor-ceremony/)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 7 of 8) (https://www.monaco-tribune.com/en/2024/10/ballon-dor-2024-jenni-hermoso-first-female-winner-of-the-socrates-prize/)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 8 of 8) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/h-s-h-prince-albert-ii-and-peace-and-sport-welcome-the-xana-foundation-winner-of-the-2025-socrates-award-in-monaco-2/)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 1 of 10) (https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/788751-oldest-winner-of-footballs-soccers-ballon-dor-award)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 2 of 10) (https://ballondor.com/news/posts/who-is-the-oldest-ballon-dor-winner)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 3 of 10) (https://ballondor.com/news/posts/who-is-the-youngest-winner-in-the-history-of-the-ballon-dor)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 4 of 10) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/ballon-dor-oldest-player-ever-100500974.html)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 5 of 10) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/yamal-break-record-youngest-ballon-10 5500980.html)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 6 of 10) (https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/articles/who-was-the-youngest-ballon-d-or-winner-2026-08-23)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 7 of 10) (https://www.si.com/soccer/the-youngest-ballon-dor-winner-ever)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 8 of 10) (https://www.givemesport.com/88101605-who-is-the-oldest-ever-ballon-dor-winner/)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 9 of 10) (https://www.oldest.org/sports/youngest-ballon-dor-winner/)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 10 of 10) (https://www.oldest.org/sports/oldest-ballon-dor-winners/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 1 of 6) (https://sportsdigest.in/youngest-golden-boot-award-winners/195571/)

- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 2 of 6) (https://worldsoccertalk.com/world-cup/list-of-world-cup-golden-boot-winners-every-top-scorer-from-1930-to-present/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 3 of 6) (https://www.si.com/soccer/2018/07/15/world-cup-golden-boot-award-winners-top-scorer-history)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 4 of 6) (https://briefly.co.za/sports/104632-ronaldo-shatters-37-year-record-after-winning-golden-boot-euro-2020-championship/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 5 of 6) (https://yen.com.gh/sports/190306-ronaldo-shatters-37-year-record-after-winning-golden-boot-euro-2020-championship/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 6 of 6) (https://onmanorama.com/sports/football/2021/07/12/european-championships-golden-boot-winners-list-ronaldo.html)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 1 of 5) (https://datencenter.dfb.de/datencenter/europameisterschaft/1996-in-england/finale/deutschland-tschechische-republik-634569)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 2 of 5) (https://datencenter.dfb.de/en/data-center/uefa-european-championship/2020-in-europe/final/2261445)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 3 of 5) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/UEFA_Euro_1996_final)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 4 of 5) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/UEFA_Euro_2020_final)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 5 of 5) (https://www.skysports.com/football/italy-vs-england/report/421532)
- **2026 men's shortlist research (2026-10-17, Run 303)** - not added to (source 1 of 2) (https://www.si.com/soccer/ballon-dor-2026-full-list-nominees)
- **2026 men's shortlist research (2026-10-17, Run 303)** - not added to (source 2 of 2) (https://thesportscast.net/2026/09/08/2026-ballon-dor-nominees-full-list-of-30-players-nominated/)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 1 of 6) (https://www.wionews.com/sports/football-french-forward-ousmane-dembele-wins-2025-ballon-d-or-spain-s-lamine-yamal-settles-for-kopa-trophy-aitana-bonmati-1758568787767/amp)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 2 of 6) (https://www.si.com/soccer/ousmane-dembele-wins-2025-ballon-dor)

- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 3 of 6) (https://thesefootballtimes.co/2017/08/23/lev-yashin-the-only-goalkeeper-to-win-the-ballon-dor/)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 4 of 6) (https://global.espn.com/football/story/_/id/38742563/why-goalkeeper-never-win-ballon-dor-again)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 5 of 6) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1995_Ballon_d%27Or)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 6 of 6) (https://www.90min.com/posts/ballon-d-or-1995-george-weah-delivers-football-s-greatest-individual-prize-to-africa)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 1 of 10) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/FIFA_Ballon_d%27Or)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 2 of 10) (https://bleacherreport.com/articles/1881792-how-is-the-ballon-dor-winner-selected)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 3 of 10) (https://www.si.com/soccer/2015/01/12/jurgen-klinsmann-ballon-dor-ballot-messi-ronaldo-neuer-robben)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 4 of 10) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/ballondor-voting.htm)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 5 of 10) (https://www.footyheadlines.com/2016/09/say-goodbye-to-fifa-ballon-dor.html)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 6 of 10) (https://www.eurosport.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2021/ballon-dor-2022-a-number-of-major-changes-to-award-have-been-confirmed-and-come-into-play-from-2022_sto8838643/story.shtml)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 7 of 10) (https://news.cgtn.com/news/2022-03-12/Ballon-d-Or-award-announces-rule-changes-after-controversial-Messi-win-18kQ17x3HZS/share_amp.html)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 8 of 10) (https://www.90min.com/fr/posts/revolution-les-4-changements-majeurs-que-va-subir-le-ballon-d-or)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 9 of 10) (https://www.jordannews.jo/Section-71/Football/3-Criteria-That-Decide-the-2026-Ballon-d-Or-How-Are-Nominees-Chosen-and-Who-Picks-the-Winner-55636)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 10 of 10) (https://foot-africa.com/en/news/ballon-dor-namibia-excluded-from-the-2025-jury-875946/)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 1 of 5) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2007_Ballon_d%27Or)

- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 2 of 5) (https://reuters.screenocean.com/record/334880)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 3 of 5) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/ballondor-2007.htm)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 4 of 5) (https://www.eurosport.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2022/black-history-month-how-george-weah-s-historic-1995-ballon-d-or-win-put-black-and-african-players-on_sto9192984/story.shtml)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 5 of 5) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/ballondor-timeline.htm)

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.